

DEPART TRAVEL SERVICES

DEPART TRAVEL SERVICES · TUNISIA

TUNISIA

Sustainable hiking, nature & local crafts — prepared for Via Verde

WHO WE ARE

Depart Travel Services is a licensed Tunisian Destination Management Company (DMC) based on the island of Djerba. We design and operate journeys across the whole of Tunisia — from the Mediterranean coast to the mountain oases of the Jebel and the dunes of the Sahara — with our own insured vehicle fleet and ONTT-certified, English-speaking tour leaders (German-speaking guides available on request). Our model is deliberately small-scale and people-centred. We work hand in hand with the families, artisans, hosts and small hoteliers who make Tunisia worth travelling, and we back every departure with 24/7 in-country support. Whether your clients travel as a couple (FIT), in a small group, or on a fully tailor-made basis, we deliver precise, dependable itineraries with the warmth of genuine local hospitality.

WHY DEPART TRAVEL — FOR VIA VERDE

Via Verde and Depart Travel Services share the same compass: culture, nature, hiking, handicrafts, sustainability and real connections with local people. Here is how our offering maps directly onto the way you build travel.

- **Sustainability at the core.** Around 95% of the accommodation we use is locally owned, roughly 90% of meals are taken in locally-owned establishments, and we pay artisans and hosts directly and fairly. We follow ABTA-aligned animal-welfare practice (every camel ride is optional), use reusable water solutions, and provide CO₂e-per-night figures — we are eCollective-ready for your carbon reporting.
- **Hiking & nature.** Our walking product takes travellers through the canyons and mountain oases of Chebika, Tamerza and Midès, along Berber trails and palm-shaded gorges — soft-adventure on foot, exactly the active-but-authentic rhythm your clients seek.
- **Local handicrafts.** Guellala pottery and Djerba weaving, harissa and olive-oil producers, cooking in family kitchens, and the Andalusian craft town of Testour — with fair, direct payment to the makers.
- **Genuine local encounters.** Tea and a meal in a Berber family home in Matmata, Berber music around the desert camp fire, conversations with hosts and growers — encounters, not performances.
- **Authentic small stays.** Locally-owned boutique and heritage *dars*, oasis hotels, a Saharan desert camp, and homestay-style and **troglodyte guesthouse** stays — the intimate, characterful properties Via Verde favours over big hotels.
- **Precise, reliable itineraries for the German market.** German FIT and small-group travellers value certainty. We provide detailed day-by-day programmes, clear inclusions, and a costed reply within 72 hours — no ambiguity.

- **A natural complement to your range.** Tunisia sits beautifully alongside your Jordan, Morocco and Oman programmes: Berber culture, desert and oasis landscapes, and deep heritage, in a compact, easy-access country a short flight from Germany.

WHY TUNISIA FOR YOUR TRAVELLERS

Tunisia packs an extraordinary range into a small, walkable country. In a single trip your clients move from Mediterranean medinas and Roman cities to the Berber south, the troglodyte villages of Matmata, the mountain oases of the Jebel, and the silence of the Sahara. Distances are short, the season is long, and direct flights from Germany are frequent and affordable.

For travellers who already love Jordan, Morocco and Oman, Tunisia offers the same draw — desert, hospitality, living craft traditions and layered history — with fewer crowds and an intimacy that suits FIT and small groups. It is, in short, a destination where sustainable, slow, people-first travel comes naturally.

RECOMMENDED FOR VIA VERDE

Best matches for your clientele first.

#	Programme	Duration	Style	Why it fits Via Verde
1	Walking Tunisia — Coast, Oases & Berber Trails	8 days	Soft-adventure walking	Hiking through canyons and mountain oases — your active, nature-led core
2	Berber South & Sahara — Beyond the Map	8–9 days	Culture & desert	Troglodyte stays, ksour and Sahara camp — deep local life, just like Jordan/Oman
3	Flavours of Tunisia	7–8 days	Handicrafts & food	Cooking with families, harissa & olive-oil makers, Andalusian Testour
4	Grand Tunisia Journey	12 days	Comprehensive	The full country for travellers wanting everything in one trip
5	Highlights of Tunisia	8 days	Classic	An accessible first-Tunisia introduction
6	Roman Tunisia	8 days	Heritage	Dougga, Sbeitla, Carthage for culture-focused clients

Walking Tunisia — Coast, Oases & Berber Trails

Overview. An eight-day soft-adventure walking journey linking the Mediterranean coast to the canyons and mountain oases of the Tunisian south. Days are paced for comfortable hiking — palm-shaded

gorges, escarpment trails and Berber paths — with nights in characterful, locally-owned stays. Ideal for FIT and small groups who want to be active without losing the cultural thread.

Key Information.

- Duration: 8 days / 7 nights
- Style: Soft-adventure walking; moderate, 3–5 hours per walking day
- Group size: Guaranteed from 2 passengers; small groups and tailor-made
- Guiding: ONTT-certified English-speaking leader (German-speaking on request)
- Best season: October–April

Highlights.

- Hiking the mountain oases and canyons of Chebika, Tamerza and Midès
- Berber trails and palm-grove walks
- A restored troglodyte guesthouse stay
- A night at a Saharan-edge desert camp with Berber music
- Locally-owned *dars* and oasis hotels throughout

Day-by-Day Itinerary.

Day 1: Arrival in Djerba

Arrive on Djerba island, where our team welcomes you and transfers you to a locally-owned island *dar*. A gentle orientation walk through the village and a welcome dinner set the tone for the week ahead.



Accommodation: Island *dar* (locally owned) · *Meals:* Dinner

Day 2: Djerba to Matmata — Berber Trails

Cross to the mainland and into the Berber highlands of Matmata. After lunch with a local family, we walk the ridge trails between troglodyte homesteads, learning how these underground dwellings keep cool in the heat.



Accommodation: Troglodyte guesthouse (homestay-style) · *Meals:* Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner

Day 3: Matmata to the Mountain Oases

A scenic transfer brings us to the foot of the Jebel. We hike into our first mountain oasis, walking among date palms and irrigation channels to a viewpoint over the plain below.



Accommodation: Oasis hotel (locally owned) · *Meals:* Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner

Day 4: Chebika & Tamerza Canyons

The signature walking day: we trek the canyon of Chebika to its waterfall, then continue along the gorge trails toward Tamerza, with a refreshing pause at a natural pool.



Accommodation: Tamerza Palace (locally owned) · *Meals:* Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner

Day 5: Midès Gorge to the Desert Edge

A morning walk through the dramatic Midès gorge, then a transfer south to the edge of the Sahara. As the sun drops, we settle into a desert camp for an evening of Berber music around the fire.



Accommodation: Saharan desert camp · *Meals:* Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner

Day 6: Desert Morning & Oasis Pools

An optional sunrise camel walk (entirely your choice), then back to greener country to relax beside spring-fed oasis pools and walk the surrounding palm groves at an easy pace.



Accommodation: Oasis hotel (locally owned) · *Meals:* Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner

Day 7: Return to the Coast via Tamerza

A final mountain walk near Tamerza before we make our way back toward the coast, with time to reflect on the week's trails and the communities who shared them.



Accommodation: Heritage dar (locally owned) · *Meals:* Breakfast, Dinner

Day 8: Departure

A relaxed morning and a last stroll before your transfer to the airport, ending where we began on Djerba.



Accommodation: — · *Meals:* Breakfast

Berber South & Sahara — Beyond the Map

Overview. An eight-to-nine-day immersion in the Berber south: the fortified granaries (ksour) of Ksar Hadada, the cliff villages of Chenini and Douiret, the troglodyte world of Matmata, and a night under the stars in the Sahara. This is deep, people-first travel — homestay-style and troglodyte stays, family meals, and music at the camp — and a perfect companion piece to your Jordan and Oman programmes.

Key Information.

- Duration: 8–9 days / 7–8 nights
- Style: Culture, Berber heritage and desert; light walking
- Group size: Guaranteed from 2 passengers; small groups and tailor-made
- Guiding: ONTT-certified English-speaking leader (German-speaking on request)
- Best season: October–April

Highlights.

- Ksar Hadada and the ksour of the south
- The cliff-side Berber villages of Chenini and Douiret
- A Berber family home and meal in Matmata
- A restored troglodyte guesthouse stay
- Camel trek and a Saharan desert camp with Berber music

Day-by-Day Itinerary.

Day 1: Arrival in Djerba

Our team meets you on Djerba and transfers you to a locally-owned island *dar*. Settle in with a welcome dinner and a short walk through the old quarter.



Accommodation: Island *dar* (locally owned) · *Meals:* Dinner

Day 2: Djerba to Ksar Hadada

We cross to the mainland and head into ksour country, exploring the vaulted granary cells of Ksar Hadada and learning how these structures protected the harvests — and identities — of southern Berber communities.



Accommodation: Heritage *dar* (locally owned) · *Meals:* Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner

Day 3: Chenini & Douiret Cliff Villages

A day among the spectacular hilltop villages of Chenini and Douiret, walking the old lanes, visiting a hillside mosque, and meeting residents who still farm the terraced slopes.



Accommodation: Heritage dar (locally owned) · *Meals:* Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner

Day 4: Into the Sahara — Camel Trek & Camp

We journey to the dunes for an optional camel trek (always your choice) into the desert, arriving at our camp for tea, sunset over the sand, and a night under a vast sky.



Accommodation: Saharan desert camp · *Meals:* Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner

Day 5: Desert Camp & Berber Music

A morning to absorb the desert's quiet, then an evening of shared food and Berber music around the fire — one of the trip's most memorable nights.



Accommodation: Saharan desert camp · *Meals:* Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner

Day 6: Sahara to Matmata

We travel to Matmata, the famous troglodyte landscape, where we are welcomed into a Berber family home for tea and a home-cooked meal, and learn the rhythms of underground living.



Accommodation: Troglodyte guesthouse (homestay-style) · *Meals:* Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner

Day 7: Matmata & the Oasis Country

A morning walk among the troglodyte dwellings, then on to greener oasis country to walk the palm groves and rest beside spring-fed pools.



Accommodation: Oasis hotel (locally owned) · *Meals:* Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner

Day 8: Return to Djerba

We make our way back toward the coast and Djerba, with a farewell dinner in a locally-owned *dar* to close the journey.



Accommodation: Island *dar* (locally owned) · *Meals:* Breakfast, Dinner

Day 9: Departure

A final morning at leisure before your transfer to Djerba airport. (Programme can be run as 8 days by combining Days 8–9.)



Accommodation: — · *Meals:* Breakfast

RESPONSIBLE TRAVEL

Responsible travel is not an add-on for us — it is how the trips are built. Around 95% of the accommodation we use is locally owned, and roughly 90% of meals are taken in locally-owned establishments, so spending stays in the communities your travellers visit. We pay artisans and hosts directly and fairly: the Guellala potters, the Djerba weavers, the harissa and olive-oil producers, and the Matmata families who open their homes all receive a fair, direct share.

We follow ABTA-aligned welfare standards — every camel ride is optional and never a condition of the experience — and we reduce waste with reusable water solutions in the field. For your reporting, we provide CO2e-per-night figures and are eCollective-ready, so Via Verde's sustainability commitments carry through to the ground in Tunisia.

PRICING

Note: All rates below are **illustrative** EUR net, land-only, per person, twin-share. Final costed quotations are tailored to your dates, group size and accommodation choices.

Programme	Duration	Illustrative net pp (twin)
Walking Tunisia — Coast, Oases & Berber Trails	8 days	from approx. €931–1,770
Berber South & Sahara — Beyond the Map	8–9 days	from approx. €931–1,770
Flavours of Tunisia	7–8 days	from approx. €931–1,770
Grand Tunisia Journey	12 days	from approx. €1,158–2,952

Commercial terms: land-only twin-share net rates; **no compulsory single supplement; guaranteed from 2 passengers**; FIT, small-group and tailor-made. We return a fully costed proposal within 72 hours of your enquiry.

LET'S WALK TUNISIA TOGETHER

Dear Birgit,

Thank you for your interest in Tunisia — it is a country that fits Via Verde's approach almost perfectly: hiking and nature, living handicrafts, genuine encounters with local people, authentic small stays, and a sustainability ethic woven through every day. We would be delighted to host you during the fam trip and to put these products into your hands.

Concrete next steps:

1. Tell us your preferred travel dates, target group size, and whether you would like a German-speaking guide.
2. Choose a lead product to develop first — we recommend **Walking Tunisia** or **Berber South & Sahara** for your clientele.
3. We return a fully costed, day-by-day proposal within 72 hours, ready for your catalogue.

Contact:

- Email: direction@depart-travel-services.com
- Phone / WhatsApp: +216 25 099 589
- Web: <https://depart-travel-services.com/fr/>

🕒 A costed response within 72 hours — guaranteed.